$20 DIGITAL GUIDE

A PRACTICAL FRUITARIAN GUIDE

The Fruit-Powered Life

Synthesizing the best lessons from **Loren Lockman**, **Ted Carr**, and **Shane Sterling** into one practical framework for eating, living, and thriving on a fruit-centered diet.

Physiology & simplicity · Real-world sustainability · Calorie discipline



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> This guide is an independent educational synthesis of publicly discussed philosophies. It is not officially affiliated with, endorsed by, or reviewed by Loren Lockman, Tanglewood Wellness Center, Ted Carr, or Shane Sterling, and it is not medical advice.

WELCOME

Three Voices, One Framework

Why this guide exists, and how to use it

Fruitarianism has three very different public faces. **Loren Lockman** (Tanglewood Wellness Center) brings the clinical, Natural Hygiene case for a low-fat, whole-food, fruit-based diet, built on decades of supervised fasting and detox work. **Ted Carr** brings the long-term practitioner's pragmatism — how to actually live this way for years without burning out, going broke, or losing your social life. **Shane Sterling** brings the discipline of numbers — the blunt truth that most fruitarian "failures" are really just *undereating*, and that consistency beats purity.

This guide pulls the strongest, most actionable ideas from each of these three approaches into one framework. It is an independent educational synthesis of publicly discussed philosophies — it is not officially affiliated with, endorsed by, or reviewed by Loren Lockman, Ted Carr, or Shane Sterling, and it is not a substitute for their own courses, coaching, or content.

Lockman

Physiology, digestion, simplicity, and the Natural Hygiene lens on why fruit works.

Carr

Budgeting, systems, flexibility, and staying fruitarian for the long haul.

Sterling

Calories, tracking, and the numbers that actually determine success.

> **Important health note:** A fruit-centered diet is a significant departure from conventional nutrition advice. It can be done well or done badly. This guide is educational, not medical advice. Talk to a doctor before making major dietary changes, especially if you're pregnant, nursing, managing a medical condition, or taking medication. Watch your bloodwork (B12, vitamin D, iron, omega-3s) periodically no matter what diet you follow.

PART 01 — IN THE SPIRIT OF LOREN LOCKMAN

The Physiological Foundation

"Simplicity heals." — the Natural Hygiene case

The clinical/fasting-tradition view of fruitarianism isn't really about fruit for its own sake — it's about **removing what burdens digestion** so the body can do its own maintenance work efficiently.

1 Low fat, not zero fat

Digestion is fastest and most efficient when meals are low in fat. Heavy fat (oils, large amounts of nuts/avocado) slows gastric emptying and thickens the blood after meals — it's the single biggest lever most raw-food dieters get wrong. Whole fruit, eaten simply, digests in a fraction of the time of a fat-heavy meal.

2 Whole fruit over juice

Juicing strips the fiber that slows sugar absorption and feeds a healthy gut. Eat the fruit, don't drink it — except as an occasional, deliberate choice (e.g., green juice alongside a meal, not as a replacement for whole food).

3 Keep combinations simple

You don't need to be a food-combining purist, but big, chaotic meals (five fruits plus nuts plus dried fruit plus oil) are harder to digest than **mono meals or simple 2–3 ingredient meals**. When in doubt, simplify.

4 The body is self-repairing when unburdened

Symptoms often labeled "detox" are the body reallocating energy away from processing dense, low-nutrient, high-fat foods toward cleanup and repair. Give it easy fuel and time.

5 Rest, sleep, sunlight, and movement are part of the diet

No eating pattern compensates for chronic sleep debt, zero sunlight, or a sedentary life. Treat these as prerequisites, not extras.

6 Water-only fasting is an advanced tool, not a starting point

It should only ever be done under qualified professional supervision (as at a facility like Tanglewood) — never self-directed, and never as a first step into this lifestyle.

> **Takeaway:** before you optimize *what fruit*, optimize *how simply you eat it*. Fewer ingredients per sitting, less added fat, more whole fruit, better sleep.

PART 02 — IN THE SPIRIT OF TED CARR

The Long-Termer's Playbook

"Make it boring, sustainable, and cheap." — pragmatism

Anyone can eat this way for two weeks. The people who stay fruitarian for years operate completely differently from how they did in month one.

1 Eat to genuine hunger, not to a rulebook

Rigid meal plans and food-combining charts are training wheels. Long-term success comes from relearning what real physical hunger feels like and trusting it — including eating more some days and less on others.

2 Budget like a grown-up

Buy fruit in bulk and in season. Build relationships with wholesalers, farmers' markets, or "ugly produce" delivery services. Ripen fruit yourself (buy it firm and let it ripen at home) rather than paying a premium for perfectly ripe fruit. Freeze gluts of ripe bananas and mangoes for later.

3 Flexibility beats purity

A rigid "I can never deviate" mindset is what causes most people to quit entirely after one social dinner "failure." Long-term practitioners build in slack: eat what's available when traveling, don't treat an imperfect meal as a moral failure, and get back to your normal pattern the next meal.

4 Design your environment, not just your willpower

Keep your kitchen stocked with ripe fruit at all times so you're never one hungry moment away from convenience food. Prep fruit in advance (peeled, cut, frozen) the way other people meal-prep.

5 Handle the social layer deliberately

Decide in advance how you'll navigate restaurants, family dinners, and travel. Eat before social events if needed, bring your own food without apology, and have a short, calm explanation ready rather than a defensive lecture.

6 Expect a real adaptation period

Energy, digestion, and cravings typically take weeks to months to stabilize — plan for a gradual transition (see Part 04), not an overnight switch.

> **Takeaway:** treat this as infrastructure — buying habits, kitchen setup, and social scripts — not just willpower. Willpower runs out; systems don't.

PART 03 — IN THE SPIRIT OF SHANE STERLING

The Numbers Discipline

"Eat enough, or none of this works." — the data-driven approach

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The most common reason people "fail" on a fruit-based diet isn't fruit itself — it's chronic **undereating**. Fruit is bulky and low-density; if you eat the way you did on a mixed diet (by volume or by old habit), you will run a large calorie deficit without noticing, and you'll blame the diet for the fatigue, mood crashes, and binge cycles that follow.

1 Know your numbers, at least at first

Track calories for a few weeks when you start (or whenever you feel low energy, lose weight unintentionally, or feel obsessive about food). Most adults doing real activity need considerably more calories from fruit than they expect — often 2,500–4,000+ kcal, which can mean 15–25+ pieces of fruit a day. This is normal on this way of eating, not a warning sign.

2 Calorie-dense fruits are your friends

Bananas, dates, mangoes, and dried fruit (in moderation) let you hit your energy needs without eating an impractical volume of watery fruit alone. Build meals around these as a base, then add watery fruits (melon, citrus, berries) for volume, hydration, and micronutrients.

3 Weigh and measure until it's intuitive

A kitchen scale removes guesswork in the first months. Once you can eyeball your needs accurately and your weight/energy are stable, you can drop formal tracking — but return to it any time something feels off.

4 Consistency beats intensity

Three solid, sufficient meals a day beats grazing on small amounts that never add up to enough. Structure your day around 2–4 substantial mono or simple meals rather than constant snacking.

5 Track outcomes, not just intake

Bodyweight trend, energy across the day, sleep quality, and mood are your feedback loop. If any of these decline for more than a couple of weeks, the fix is almost always "eat more," not "eat differently."

6 Test, don't guess, on supplementation

Get B12 tested and supplement if needed — this is non-negotiable on any diet with little or no animal food, whatever theory you subscribe to. Track vitamin D and iron too, especially if sun exposure or menstrual status make you higher-risk.

> **Takeaway:** when in doubt, the answer is almost always "you're not eating enough." Track it, don't assume it.

PART 04 — PUTTING IT TOGETHER

The 30-Day Transition Framework

Simplify digestion first, build systems second, lock in sufficient intake third

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Week 1 — Simplify

- Cut added oils and reduce nuts/seeds to a small daily handful at most.
- Replace one meal a day with a mono or 2-ingredient fruit meal.
- Start a simple food + energy + mood log (doesn't need to be calories yet).

Week 2 — Build the system

- Set up your fruit-buying routine: bulk source, ripening station, freezer stash.
- Replace a second meal with fruit; keep your remaining meal familiar and comfortable.
- Write your one-paragraph "social script" for explaining your diet, and practice it once.

Week 3 — Add the numbers

- Go to all-fruit meals for the day (or as close as your context allows).
- Start weighing/tracking calories for at least a few days to see where you actually land versus where you assume you land.
- Anchor each meal around a calorie-dense fruit (banana, date, mango) plus a watery fruit for volume.

Week 4 — Stabilize and observe

- Hold your new pattern for a full week.
- Review your log: is bodyweight stable (unless intentionally changing), is energy even across the day, is sleep good?
- Adjust total intake up before you change anything else if any of those are off.

After 30 days you should have (a) a digestion-friendly, simplified eating pattern, (b) a repeatable buying/prep system, and (c) a working sense of your real caloric needs. From here, the diet becomes maintenance, not a project.

PART 05

Troubleshooting

Fast fixes for the six problems everyone hits

"I'm exhausted all the time."

Almost always insufficient calories. Add a calorie-dense fruit meal before touching anything else.

"I'm losing weight I don't want to lose."

Same root cause. Increase portion sizes and meal frequency, lean harder on bananas, dates, and dried fruit.

"My teeth feel sensitive / I'm worried about sugar and teeth."

Rinse with water after fruit meals, wait before brushing, and don't sip fruit slowly over hours — eat meals, then stop, rather than grazing all day, which is what actually drives dental issues on any high-sugar diet.

"I feel great for weeks, then crash."

Check for a slow calorie deficit that built up unnoticed, and check sleep and stress — both compound quickly on a lean diet.

"Social situations are stressful."

Eat before you go, bring your own food matter-of-factly, and use your prepared explanation once — then stop justifying yourself. Long-term practitioners stop apologizing for their diet; that shift alone removes most of the social friction.

"I don't know if I'm combining/ordering my food correctly."

Stop optimizing combining rules and just simplify the meal. Fewer ingredients solves 90% of digestive-comfort questions without needing a chart.

APPENDICES

Reference & Tools

Sample day, shopping checklist, and FAQ

A · Sample Day (adjust portions to your own calorie needs)

- **Morning:** Large mono meal — 6–8 bananas, or a big bowl of mango.
- **Midday:** Melon meal (half a watermelon or cantaloupe) for hydration and volume.
- **Afternoon:** Dates plus a handful of berries, or dried fruit if calorie needs are high.
- **Evening:** Mixed simple meal — e.g., oranges and persimmons, or a large fruit salad kept to 2–3 fruit types.

B · Shopping & Prep Checklist

- [ ] Identify a bulk/wholesale or farmers' market source for your staple fruits
- [ ] Buy bananas and other climacteric fruit slightly underripe; ripen at home in batches
- [ ] Freeze overripe bananas and mangoes for smoothies or cold desserts
- [ ] Keep a kitchen scale accessible for the first month
- [ ] Stock 3–4 "anchor" calorie-dense fruits at all times (bananas, dates, mangoes, dried fruit)
- [ ] Prep a grab-and-go fruit container for busy days

C · FAQ

Do I need to be 100% fruit to benefit from this?

No. Every principle here (simplify meals, build sustainable systems, eat enough) helps at any percentage of fruit in your diet.

Is this medically endorsed?

This guide reflects publicly discussed philosophies associated with these practitioners' work; it is educational only. Work with a doctor or registered dietitian for personalized medical guidance, and get regular bloodwork.

What if I don't have access to cheap tropical fruit?

Lean on what's abundant and affordable locally — apples, pears, grapes, citrus, melon in season — and use dried fruit and frozen fruit to fill gaps affordably.

The Fruit-Powered Life

Three proven philosophies. One practical framework. Everything you need to start, sustain, and troubleshoot a fruit-centered way of eating — without guesswork.

🍌 Physiological foundation · 🍊 Real-world sustainability · 🥭 Calorie discipline

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